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Last week: DJIA 46245.41 ▼ 902.07 1.91% NASDAQ 22273.08 ▼ 2.7% STOXX 600 562.10 ▼ 2.2% 10-YR. TREASURY ▲ 22/32, yield 4.062% OIL \$58.06 ▼ \$2.03 EURO \$1.1514 YEN 156.39

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Boston Fed president** Susan Collins said she sees no strong need for another interest-rate cut next month, underscoring the challenge Powell faces in building consensus among central bank officials at its next meeting in December. **A2**

◆ **Wall Street is straining** to absorb a flood of new bonds from tech companies funding their artificial-intelligence investments, adding to the recent pressure in markets. **A1**

◆ **“Wicked: For Good”** gave movie theaters a much-needed boost with a smash-hit opening that Hollywood hopes will launch a strong end to a soft year. **B1, B2**

◆ **“Now You See Me: Now You Don’t”** was the runner up at the weekend domestic box office, pulling in \$9.1 million for a total of \$36.8 million since its release. **B2**

◆ **BHP said it wouldn’t** pursue a takeover of Anglo American following new talks, clearing the way for its U.K. rival to close a merger with Teck Resources. **B2**

◆ **The owner of the U.K.’s Daily Mail** is in exclusive talks to buy upmarket rival the Daily Telegraph, in a deal that would create a powerhouse in British right-wing media. **B3**

◆ **Selling data on private equity** and private credit is becoming big business on Wall Street, threading a needle in a market where opacity is the point. **B1**

◆ **More buyout professionals** are considering taking roles outside private equity, according to a forthcoming report from Odyssey Search Partners. **B5**

World-Wide

◆ **The White House** said it and Ukraine modified the Trump administration’s proposed plan for ending the war with Russia, resulting in an “updated and refined peace framework” during talks in Geneva. **A6**

◆ **Trump said he was** ending temporary immigration protections for a group of Somalis living in Minnesota, initiating a new front in the president’s mass-deportation push. **A3**

◆ **The president renewed** calls for federal intervention to stem crime in Chicago after shootings left a 14-year-old dead and eight other teens wounded. **A3**

◆ **Families are likely to** spend 5% less on Thanksgiving dinner this year compared with last, laying out an average of \$55.18 to feed a group of 10, the American Farm Bureau Federation estimated. **A3**

◆ **With the House** returning this month after 54 days out of session, interpersonal dramas and long-running feuds burst into the open, sometimes turning members against their own parties. **A4**

◆ **The federal prosecution** of former FBI director James Comey is teetering after a series of missteps, a sign of broader challenges ahead for the Justice Department as it pursues cases that Trump favors. **A5**

◆ **Gunmen stormed a** Catholic school in Nigeria, abducting more than 300 students and teachers at a time when Trump is threatening military action to protect Christians in the West African nation. **A9**

JOURNAL REPORT

Encore: They planned retirement perfectly. Then one of them got sick. **R1-10**

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Israeli Strike Kills a Hezbollah Leader in Beirut



TARGET: People gathered Sunday below a residential building in Beirut where a strike left five people dead and injured 28, Lebanese authorities said. Israel said the attack killed a leader of the militant group Hezbollah’s rearmament effort. **A9**

For Hobbled Zelensky, Defying Trump Is Safer Than Yielding

Ukrainian public’s firm stance on war makes a deal favoring Putin political suicide

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

Buffed by a corruption scandal that has sparked fury across Ukraine, President Volodymyr Zelensky is in political trouble at home, weaker than at any point since the full-scale Russian invasion of his country began nearly four years ago.

Yet, this very vulnerability makes him even less likely to yield to the Trump administra-

tion, which is pushing a 28-point plan that was secretly drafted by White House special envoy Steve Witkoff and Kremlin adviser Kirill Dmitriev. Zelensky has described the initial text, released by Washington shortly after the corruption affair in Kyiv erupted, as forcing Ukraine to give up its dignity and freedom.

“Trump seems to repeat the mistakes that Putin already made several times, underestimating the strength of Ukrainian society and not understanding what Ukraine really is,” said Nico Lange, a former senior German defense official who is involved in European efforts to help Ukraine. “No

Ukrainian president—and especially not a weakened Zelensky—has a mandate to agree to anything like this. If he does, he would not be president anymore when he comes home.”

U.S. officials led by Witkoff and Secretary of State Marco Rubio; a Ukrainian team led by Zelensky’s chief of staff Andriy Yermak, who has been facing calls to resign by Ukrainian lawmakers; and national-security advisers from European nations came to Geneva on Sunday to discuss the plan, which President Trump has said he wants signed by Thanksgiving.

Despite widespread weariness of war and desire for

peace, Ukrainians overwhelmingly view this latest U.S.-Russian proposal as a veiled capitulation—one that isn’t justified by the situation on the battlefield, where Russia has made slow advances at a tremendous cost. While Ukrainian politicians generally support the idea of talks, none have endorsed the plan’s key demand to give up cities that Russia doesn’t control.

“Our society is not ready to surrender. It wasn’t ready to

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- ◆ **U.S. says talks yield modified peace plan..... A6**
- ◆ **Key Russian demands turn up in Trump proposal..... A6**

Flood of AI Bonds Heightens Market Pressure

Falling debt prices increase investors’ anxieties about stock valuations

By SAM GOLDFARB

Wall Street is straining to absorb a flood of new bonds from tech companies funding their artificial-intelligence investments, adding to the recent pressure in markets.

Since the start of September, AI hyperscalers Amazon.com, Alphabet, Meta Platforms and Oracle have issued nearly \$90 billion of investment-grade bonds, according to Dealogic, more than they had sold over the previous 40 months.

AI data-center developers like TeraWulf and Cipher Mining, both started as bitcoin miners, also have stormed the speculative-grade market, issuing more than \$7 billion of those lower-rated bonds.

Companies were able to complete their sales. But some had to pay unexpectedly high interest rates. Prices of bonds from the companies have also been sliding—a sign that investors were caught off guard by the quantity of bonds entering the market and of growing concern about the worsening credit metrics of the businesses.

Stock investors, already nervous about the sky-high valuations of AI businesses, have taken note of the weakness in the bond market. Meanwhile, the cost of insuring those bonds using credit-default swaps also has climbed, with negative sentiments from different groups of investors feeding into each other.

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◆ **James Mackintosh: ‘Fake it til you make it’ gets old... B1**

Cigarette Chic Makes Comeback, Thanks to Celebrities

By LAURA COOPER AND TERELL WRIGHT

The stars are lighting up again.

“Need a cigarette to make me feel better,” crooned pop star Addison Rae on her 2025 single “Headphones On,” while Lorde sang “this is the best cigarette of my life” in her own 2025 release, “What Was That.” Sabrina Carpenter was recently photographed wearing a corset made of Marlboro Gold packages, and sells shirts with song names emblazoned on mock-ups of cigarette boxes and lighters.

On the silver screen, about half of all movies that made their debut last year included appearances of cigarettes, cigars and other tobacco products, up 10% from the previous year, according to a new report from public health nonprofit Truth Initiative and research organization NORC at the University of Chicago.

With more actors, pop stars and other celebrities spotted unapologetically smoking, the cultural taboo against it shows signs of ebbing. That worries antismoking advocates, who fear a reversal of the years-long decline in U.S. smoking rates.

“I find that concerning, glamorous, attractive people smoking cigarettes,” said Ollie Ganz, an assistant professor at the Rutgers School of Public

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U.S. NEWS

For some young conservative women, a career takes a back seat to having kids. **A3**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

After a year of anxiety, executives are starting to chill out about Trump’s tariffs. **B1**

Inside the Strange and Lonely Test Run of a New Cruise Ship

Before a ship’s debut, employees kick the tires in what’s known as a ‘shakedown’

By JACOB PASSY

As a country-western band plucked out a twangy cover of a Beyoncé hit, I grapevined and box-stepped alongside fellow passengers aboard the Celebrity Xcel, the premium cruise line’s newest vessel.

Such a scene might not seem unusual for a Friday night on a cruise ship, but this wasn’t a typical sailing. And neither I nor my fellow line dancers were your standard cruise passengers.

We were on the Xcel for its “shakedown cruise,” a final test run new ships often go through before making their

public debuts. Aside from me, everyone onboard was an employee from Celebrity Cruises parent, Royal Caribbean Group, or their guest.

Days before the Champagne bottle was broken over the bow for its maiden voyage last week, I boarded the ship to watch the final preparations. Every detail was scrutinized, from the comfort of each chair to the texture of napkins. Changes were ordered on the fly in response to feedback. The paint color on one restaurant facade was too muted. The dance moves at the Saddle Up Saloon were too hard.

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Google Leapfrogs Rivals on Chatbot

By KATHERINE BLUNT

Call it America’s next top model.

With the release of its third version last week, Google’s Gemini large language model surged past ChatGPT and other competitors to become the most capable AI chatbot, as determined by consensus industry-benchmark tests.

The results represent public validation for Google employees who, for months, have been conducting their own, personal tests of the model—asking it for jokes, trying to stump it with math problems—and coming away con-

vinced they had something that would finally tilt the LLM field in the company’s favor.

For one of her “vibe checks,” Tulsee Doshi, Gemini’s senior director of product management, asked the model to write in Gujarati, a language spoken widely in India but not especially prevalent on the internet. The results were far better than what she had gotten from earlier models.

“I call it signs of life, right?” she said. “People were coming back and saying, ‘I feel it, I think we’ve hit on something.’”

Aaron Levie, chief executive

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How Marriott’s Bet On Sonder Blew Up

Apartment-rental firm collapsed under high-cost leases, causing chaos

By KATHERINE HAMILTON AND CRAIG KARMIN

For Marriott International, the \$15 million deal seemed like a low-risk way to add 9,000 rooms to its global portfolio.

So in August of last year, the world’s largest hotel chain struck a licensing agreement with an upstart short-term rental company called Sonder, whose twist on Airbnb-style booking was to provide guests with hotel amenities at apartment-like units across three continents.

Marriott customers, who earned loyalty points by booking Sonder units, liked the option enough that a few thousand were settled into Sonder rooms on Nov. 9 when a puzzling email arrived from Marriott: “We are kindly requesting that you check out of the property as soon as you are able.”

“Everything kind of went straight downhill from there,” recalled Cassia Francois, a senior hospitality manager at a Sonder property in the Tribeca neighbor-

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